Republic of the Philippines • Department of Education
Region VI – Western Visayas • Schools Division of Roxas City
BAGO NATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL • Bago, Roxas City

Learner's Handout: Writing Your Research Methodology

Grade 11 Practical Research 1 • Term 2, Week 9 • Nov 9–13, 2026

Name: _____ Section: _____

How to use this handout. Read the notes, study the examples, then answer the practice items in your notebook. A notebook is enough: no printing, travel, fieldwork, or interviews are needed this week. Do one part a day if you are busy. Share your work when your teacher allows.

Safety first: Study only when safe and well; follow your school's announcements.

1. What is a written research methodology?

The **research methodology** is the part of your research paper that tells **how** you will do your study. In Week 8 you made notes about your design, participants, and steps. This week you turn those notes into short, clear paragraphs.

A qualitative methodology has **six parts**, written in this order:

1. **Research design**: names the design (case study, phenomenology, narrative, etc.) and tells why it fits.
2. **Participants and sampling**: who, how many, and how they are chosen.
3. **Research locale**: where the study will be done.
4. **Instrument**: the tool you use to gather data, usually a **semi-structured interview guide**.
5. **Data collection procedure**: the steps you will follow, in order.
6. **Data analysis and ethics**: how you will find themes, and how you will protect participants.

2. Short notes on each part

Research design. Use the frame: *"This study will use ___ because …"*. Always give a reason. Example reasons: phenomenology for *lived experiences* of a group; case study for an *in-depth look at one* person, place, or group; narrative for *one person's life story*.

Participants and sampling. Qualitative studies usually use **purposive sampling**: you choose people who fit your **inclusion criteria** (the rules for who may join, e.g., "has sold fish for at least 2 years"). About **5–10 participants** is enough; you may stop when their answers start to repeat. "Anyone who passes by" is **not** purposive.

Research locale. Name the exact place, e.g., Roxas City Fish Port, or Brgy. Bago, Roxas City.

Instrument. A **semi-structured interview guide** is a list of prepared questions (from your SOP) that still lets you ask follow-up questions.

Data collection procedure (6 steps). (1) Ask **permission** from the people in charge. (2) Get **informed consent** from each participant. (3) **Interview** using the guide. (4) **Record**, only with permission. (5) **Transcribe**: write the answers word for word. (6) Use **codes** (P1, P2) instead of real names.

Data analysis. Use **thematic analysis** in five steps: **transcribe → read → code → group → theme**. A **code** is a short label for one important idea. Similar codes are grouped, and each group gets a **theme** (its main idea).

Ethics. Four practices: **permission**, **informed consent**, **voluntary participation** (a participant may stop anytime), and **privacy** (use codes, never real names).

3. Key terms

Methodology: the part of the paper that explains how the study will be done.

Purposive sampling: choosing participants on purpose because they fit set criteria.

Inclusion criteria: the qualities a person must have to join the study.

Locale: the place where the study is done.

Semi-structured interview guide: prepared questions with room for follow-up questions.

Informed consent: the participant understands the study and agrees, usually in writing.

Voluntary participation: joining is a free choice; a participant may stop anytime.

Transcribe: write down recorded answers word for word.

Code: a short label for an important idea in an answer.

Theme: the main idea that a group of similar codes shares.

4. Worked example: the fish-vendor study

Teacher-made sample for learning only. This is not a real study and not real data.

Topic: The experiences of fish vendors at the Roxas City Fish Port when the catch is low.

1. Research design

This study will use phenomenology because it wants to understand the lived experiences of fish vendors when the catch is low.

2. Participants and sampling

The participants are fish vendors. Eight (8) vendors will be interviewed, or until their answers start to repeat. They will be chosen through purposive sampling: each has sold fish at the Fish Port for at least 2 years and agrees to be interviewed.

3. Research locale

The study will be done at the Roxas City Fish Port in Roxas City, Capiz, where the vendors work.

4. Instrument

The researchers will use a semi-structured interview guide based on the Statement of the Problem.

5. Data collection procedure

First, we will send a letter of permission to the people in charge of the Fish Port. Next, each vendor will sign an informed consent form. Then we will interview each vendor using the guide and audio-record the interview with permission. After that, we will transcribe the recordings and use codes (P1, P2) instead of real names.

6. Data analysis and ethics

We will transcribe, read, code, group, and name themes. Example: the codes “less income when catch is low,” “fewer buyers, less money,” and “borrowing to keep selling” form the theme **Income loss**. Participation is voluntary, and vendors may stop anytime. Real names will not be used.

5. Practice: answer in your notebook

Answer what you can. Items 1–7 are short; items 8–10 use your own group’s study. Use your Week 8 notes and interview guide.

1 Write the six parts of a written research methodology in the correct order.

2 Which design fits best: *“the life story of one tricycle driver in Roxas City”*? Choose: phenomenology, case study, or narrative. Give one reason.

3 Group A will interview 2 sari-sari store owners. Group B will interview 8 owners, or until answers repeat. Which plan fits a qualitative interview study? Why?

4 Fitting or not fitting? *“We will interview anyone who passes by the plaza.”* Explain in one sentence.

5 Put these steps in order (write the letters):
A. Interview using the guide
B. Transcribe the recording
C. Ask permission from the barangay captain
D. Use codes instead of real names
E. Get informed consent
F. Audio-record with permission

6 Read these codes from interviews with tricycle drivers in Brgy. Bago: *“fewer passengers when it rains,” “spending more on gasoline,” “extra trips at night.”* Write one theme that joins them.

7 Fix this unethical line: *“We recorded Aling Rosa Dela Cruz, a store owner in Brgy. Bago, without telling her.”* Name two problems and rewrite it.

8 Your study: complete the frame *“This study will use ___ because …”*.

9 Your study: write one inclusion criterion for your participants and one sentence naming your locale.

10 Your study: check your whole draft with the checklist below. Write which part you still need to improve.

6. Six-point checklist for your methodology

[ ] 1. Research design is named and has a reason (because…).

[ ] 2. Participants and sampling: who, how many (about 5–10), how chosen (purposive + criteria).

[ ] 3. Research locale is named.

[ ] 4. Instrument is named (semi-structured interview guide).

[ ] 5. Procedure is in order: permission → consent → interview → record → transcribe → codes.

[ ] 6. Analysis steps and ethics: consent, voluntary participation, privacy (codes).

Next: after your methodology is checked, you will learn how to collect data through observation and interviews. Keep your notebook and interview guide ready. Do not start interviews until your teacher says so.